

Important Directions

- **Read through all slides**
 - **Watch all videos**

Physical and Cognitive Development in Early Childhood

Main Traits and Accomplishments of the Four Stages of Cognitive Development in Jean Piaget's Theory

Stage of Cognitive Development	Traits and Accomplishments
Sensorimotor stage (0 to 2 years old)	<i>Cognition is practical.</i> ("I see and touch, therefore I know") Object permanence Deferred imitation Mean-Goals mental coordination
Preoperational stage (2 to 7 years old)	<i>Cognition is symbolic and intuitive.</i> ("I can think with my head, without my hands, but logic escapes me and appearance is reality") Expression of the symbolic function (for example, images, language, drawing, symbolic play) Magical thinking (for example, animism, finalism, artificialism, realism)
Concrete operational stage (7 to 11 years old)	<i>Cognition becomes logical, although restricted to concrete entities.</i> ("I can do it without hands and with logic, but my logic fails a bit if problems are not touchable") Conservation Classification Seriation
Formal operational stage (11 to 16 years old)	<i>Cognition becomes logical and abstract.</i> ("I can think and solve problems proficiently without the need of concrete stuff, and I can even imagine many other possibilities") Hypothetico-deductive thinking Abstract thinking

Preoperational Period (2-7 years)

- Thinking is symbolic, no longer limited to their physical environment.
- Able to mentally represent concepts and engage with them
- Thinking is not logical, at first. Perception is reality.
 - Children do not realize that the appearance of things doesn't change its properties
 - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gnArvcWaH6I>

Preoperational Period (2-7 years)

- **Egocentrism:** interpret events and objects only from one's own perspective
- Difficulty in considering all factors when making a decision
 - Think about the conservation task, children are stuck on the height of the glass, and don't consider the width of it.
 - Age by Height: Children judge age based on height. Shorter people are younger and vice versa.

Theory of Mind



Theory of Mind: False- belief tasks

- Smarties task: (Sharpies task)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8hLubgpY2_w
- Sally Anne Task
- <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QjkTQtggLH4>
- Deception tasks
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TJkB6nrk1CA#t=84>
- 3 year olds consistently fail false-belief tasks
- But there is some evidence that even younger children understand other people's desires

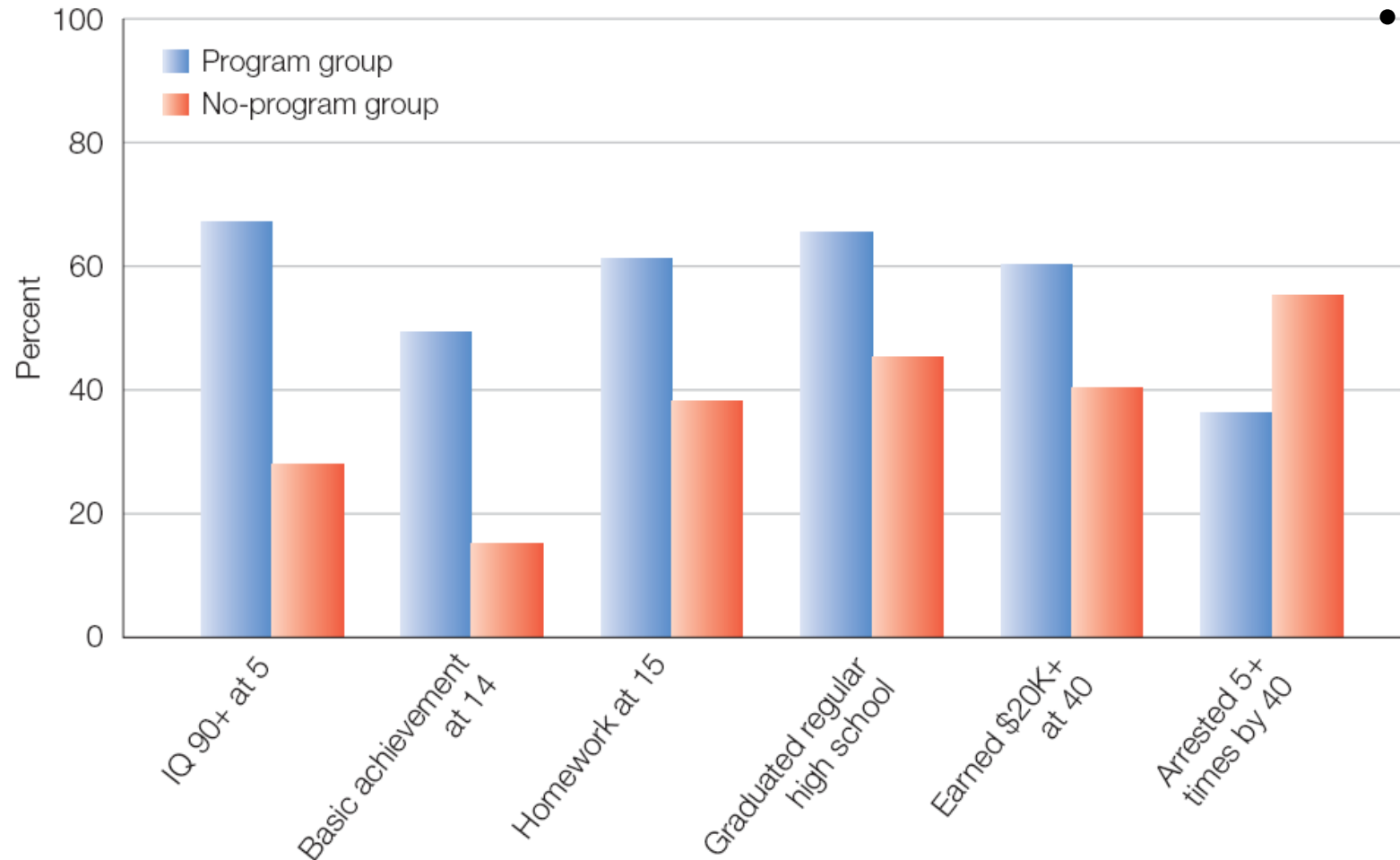
Effects of Preschool Attendance

- Some effects include
 - Higher verbal skills, stronger performance on memory, and listening comprehension
 - Children from low-income families who attend preschool score higher on school readiness
 - Social children are more independent and confident
 - Negative effects include less compliance, less respectful of authority figures and more aggression
 - Vast differences in the quality of different pre-schools- Quality more important than whether a preschool is attended.

The Importance of Preschool Quality

- Important features of high quality centers include
 - Education and training of teachers
 - Class size and child-teacher ratio
 - Age-appropriate materials and activities
 - Teacher-child interactions
- Focus for high quality is developmentally appropriate educational practice

Preschool as a Cognitive Intervention



- High Scope Preschool Project

- Full-day, two-year intervention program
- Similar IQ effects as Project Head Start but other long-term effects
- Increased chance of graduating from high school and attending college
- Less likely to become pregnant or arrested
- Increased income and family stability

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FB3_zMwHods

Physical Development in Early Childhood

Brain Development

- Size of brain increases gradually during early childhood
- Frontal lobe growth underlies advances in emotional regulation, foresight, and planned behavior
- Corpus callosum has myelination peak during early childhood
- Cerebellum has increased myelination as well, which helps with balance

Infantile amnesia

- Infantile amnesia – inability to remember anything that happened prior to age 2
- Explicit sense of self
- Language
- Memory development

Socio-Emotional Development in Early Childhood

Emotional Regulation

- Emotional self-regulation important for social relationships
- Extreme emotional expressions decline with age
- Effortful control allows children to focus attention on managing emotions
- Childhood self regulation is one of the most important predictors of lifelong success- **academic achievement, employment prospects, health, wealth and happiness in adulthood**
- What other variable can you say is responsible for these outcomes?
- Self-regulation predicts these outcomes over and above intelligence!
- The Marshmallow Test
- **https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QX_oy9614HQ**

Baumrind's Parenting Styles Theory

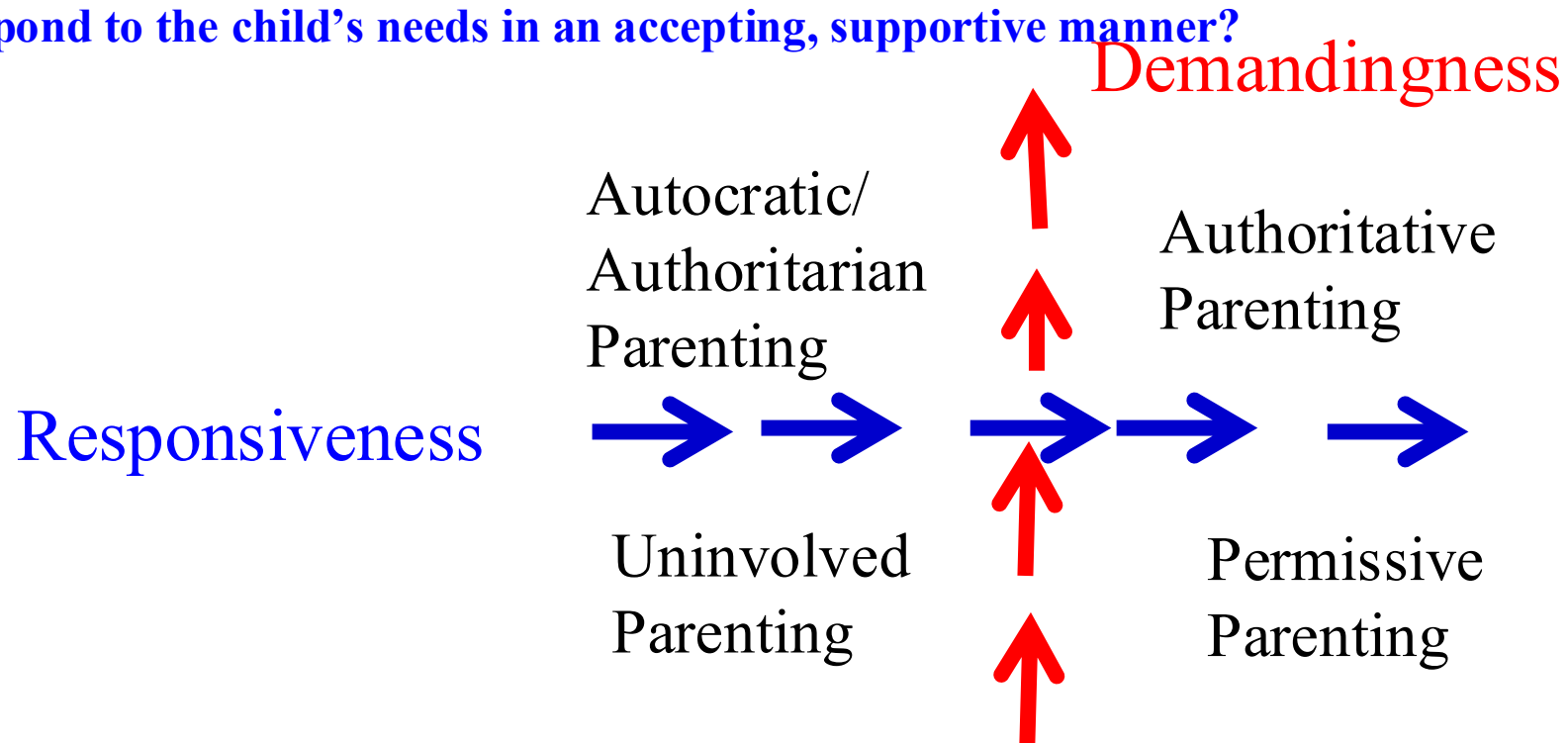
- Two important parenting behaviors:

1) **Demandingness:** Rules and expectations for behaviors.

Do parents set/communicate expectations for mature behavior from the child?

1) **Responsiveness:** Warmth and support.

Do parents respond to the child's needs in an accepting, supportive manner?



Authoritative parenting

- Set clear standards
- Enforce rules with warmth and explanations
- Listen to children's perspectives and make exceptions accordingly
- Goal- Self-regulated behavior of children-not just following arbitrary rules

<https://youtu.be/qHRWZEnNvHA?t=4>

How do the children turn out?

Children more

- responsible,
- self-reliant,
- creative,
- intellectually curious,
- high self esteem, socially and
- academically successful.

Authoritarian parenting

- Exert strict rules and demand absolute compliance.
 - Critical evaluation of child behavior
 - Little verbal give and take
 - Does not value autonomy
 - Emotionally rejecting

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JqwDhzGmnHU>

How do the children turn out?

Children likely to be more

- Dependent
- Withdrawn
- Discontented
- Distrustful of others
- Low self-esteem
- Poor academic and social adjustment

Indulgent parenting

- Non-demanding and warm
- Little exercise of parental control
- Parents are very concerned about children's happiness and self-reliance
- Very involved- lack of control is by principle

How do the children turn out?

- Children
- Lack self-control and self-regulation
- Lack self- reliance
- Aggressive or impulsive
- Greater psychosocial difficulties during adolescence than seen in authoritarian families.

Uninvolved parenting

Parents are

- Disengaged from children
- Emotionally cold and indifferent
 - Self- involved
- Termed neglectful since their actions are potentially harmful for children

How do the children turn out?

- Disruption in attachment relationships as infants and toddlers
- As teenagers, likely to engage in delinquent activities as well as precocious sexual or substance use activities.
- Internalizing problems such as depression and social withdrawal.

Table 6.2 Outcomes Associated with Parenting Styles in White Middle-Class Families

Authoritative	Authoritarian	Permissive	Disengaged
Independent	Dependent	Irresponsible	Impulsive
Creative	Passive	Conforming	Behavior problems
Self-assured	Conforming	Immature	Early sex, drugs
Socially skilled			

3 year old Indira is generally not able to sit still and quietly through a whole meal at a restaurant. You see children her age accomplishing this goal.

- ★ • A) You tell her what kind of behavior you expect and give reminders during the meal. If she does well, you give her a treat but if not, you say “Too bad, I hope you get the treat next time.”
- B) You tell her what kind of behavior you expect and give reminders during the meal. If she does well, you give her a treat but if not, you scold her or spank her in the restroom.
- C) You tell her what is expected, but you want to have a pleasant meal, so you tolerate the misbehavior, hoping it will improve as she has greater self- control.
- ★ • D) You think she is behind, so you explain her how this behavior bothers other people, so she will learn the consequences of her actions.

Gershoff, 2016

- Combines findings from research over 5 decades with more than 160,000 children
- What are the main findings – What are the effects of spanking children over time?

Important findings

- Spanking (defined as an open-handed hit on the behind or extremities) was significantly linked with 13 of the 17 outcomes they examined, all in the direction of detrimental outcomes.

Table 2
Summary of Spanking Meta-Analyses by Outcome

Detrimental child outcome	<i>K</i>	Spank <i>n</i>	No Spank <i>n</i>	<i>d</i>	95% CI		<i>Z</i>	<i>I</i> ²
Immediate defiance	5	120	30	.14	-.19	.47	.85	.80%
Low moral internalization	8	745	84	.38	.11	.65	2.76***	67.40%
Child aggression	7	4,534	1,069	.37	.13	.61	3.07***	91.40%
Child antisocial behavior	9	5,725	1,086	.39	.24	.53	5.28***	84.50%
Child externalizing behavior problems	14	25,988	1,086	.41	.32	.50	9.19***	88.40%
Child internalizing behavior problems	8	12,413	3,486	.24	.13	.35	4.36***	88.50%
Child mental health problems	10	5,122	1,313	.53	.42	.64	5.17***	76.00%
Child alcohol or substance abuse	3	6,621	90,359	.09	-.11	.29	.90	91.30%
Negative parent-child relationship	5	755	0	.51	.36	.66	6.76***	.00%
Impaired cognitive ability	8	8,358	11	.17	.01	.32	2.13*	84.30%
Low self-esteem	3	766	990	.15	.04	.26	2.76**	.00%
Low self-regulation	3	2,525	0	.30	-.07	.67	1.58	94.30%
Victim of physical abuse	8	3,334	996	.64	.39	1.74	4.07***	93.30%
Adult antisocial behavior	3	985	4,206	.36	.06	.65	2.35**	92.00%
Adult mental health problems	8	1,855	4,707	.24	.09	.40	3.05**	73.20%
Adult alcohol or substance abuse	4	2,596	4,796	.13	-.08	.35	1.21	91.90%
Adult support for physical punishment	5	1,016	177	.38	.15	.61	3.28***	55.50%
Overall effect size	111	89,638	114,722	.33	.29	.38	14.84***	88.80%

Note. *K* = number of effect sizes in the meta-analysis; *d* = mean weighted effect size; *Z* = significance test that *d* differs from zero; *I*² = the variation in the mean effect size attributable to heterogeneity. Bolded effect sizes are significantly different from zero.

* *p* < .05. ** *p* < .01. *** *p* < .001.

Corporal Punishment Outcomes

- Officially outlawed in many countries. Most psychologists advice against it.
- Although it alters a child's immediate behavior, associated with poorer mental outcomes.
- Harms parent child relationship.
- Escalates violent behavior. Counterproductive in reducing aggression and bad behavior.
- Painful, hard to encode the real message. Far from being empathic as a parent.

REFRAME THE BEHAVIOUR

"KIDS DO WELL IF THEY CAN"
~ROSS GREENE



"SEE A CHILD DIFFERENTLY, YOU SEE A DIFFERENT CHILD"
~Dr. Stuart Shanker

When kids exhibit challenging behaviour we can be
"STRESS DETECTIVES"... finding and removing barriers.

- FIND STRESSORS → REDUCE THEM
- FIND UNMET NEEDS → MEET THEM
- FIND SKILLS DEFICITS → TEACH THEM

@kwfens62

The role of emotions in parenting

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YsvQ7SsEFdQ>
- This three year old is teaching her mother how to deal with difficult emotions, and very importantly, **in a gentle and empathic way.**
 - She is using an **emotion coaching approach.**
- She has **learned this** because her **caregivers** have treated her emotions (especially negative ones) with empathy and patience.
- They have responded to her upsets with warmth and genuine concern, as opposed to dismissing them.
 - Parents' reactions to children's emotions teach children about emotions-especially how to deal with them.

Parent-child relationships and bids for connection

- In all relationships, we make bids for attention, comfort, play.
- Children make bids for parent's attention.
- “Can you play with me?”, “Can you comfort me?”, “Can you help me?”
- A tantrum is a bid- for attention and connection.
- When bids are met: we make deposits in the emotional bank account. **We build trust and security in the relationship.**
- When bids are not met or ignored: we withdraw from this emotional bank account. **We lose trust and security in the relationship.**
- When we are abrasive, violent or simply unavailable-we are making withdrawals from our relationship bank account with our children.
- The parent-child relationship quality diminishes



The role of Emotions in parenting

- Emotional Intelligence is key to later success in life
- Challenges to meeting bids: We may not see them as bids
- Or we are uncomfortable, due to our emotional philosophy

Every parent has a Meta-emotion

- Our Philosophy about Emotions
- Our beliefs about the usefulness, meaningfulness of emotions.
- Attitudes about emotions
- E.g.. Are emotions good or bad? Is it good to talk about them or not?
Are they private or public? Ok to show them or not?
- Develops in early family contexts
- Governs our comfort and attitudes in future relationships.
- Emotion Related Parenting Style

Emotion Related Parenting Styles (Gottman et al. 1996)

- Emotion Coaching vs Emotion Dismissing
- Dismissing parents are often warm and well meaning
 - BUT
- Uncomfortable with negative emotions, focused on dismissing them quickly. Uncomfortable with sadness or anger
- View negative emotions as toxic, and believe that it is their role to get their child out of negative mood as quickly as possible
- Children socialized to dismiss their own emotions.

Emotion Related Parenting Style (Gottman et al. 1996)

Emotion Coaching- parents use emotional moments to create closeness and intimacy.

- “I feel close to my child when he is sad”
- “When my child is sad, I let her know that I understand”
- “When Markie is sad I want to know what he is thinking”
- “It makes me want to hold him close”

Emotion Dismissing- parents Dismiss or disapprove emotions

- “Seeing my child sad makes me uncomfortable”
- “I think sadness is OK as long as it is under control”
- “A child’s anger deserves a time-out”
- “I get annoyed when my child acts sad”
- “Children often act sad to get their way”

Emotion Related Parenting Style (Gottman et al. 1996)

Emotion Coaching- parents think emotions are useful

- “Anger gives me energy and drive”- Purposeful
- “When I am sad, I know something is missing from my life”- Purposeful
- “Sadness tells you to slow down”- Purposeful
- “Getting angry can be a relief, like a storm that finally happens”- Helps reset

Emotion Dismissing- parents think emotions are NOT useful

- “When people get angry they are just relieving themselves on others”- (Inconsiderate to be angry)
- Loss of control, humiliation in public (Shameful)
- Anger was compared to violence- Comparison to fire, pressure, heat (Dangerous, Scary)
- Sadness was compared to defeat, hopelessness, and pathology. (Weakness)